

Guidance

Some Biblical Principles

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神的引導

一些聖經的原則

奧利華·R·百其利著

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1 The fact of guidance

Christians have rarely been in doubt as to the fact of divine guidance. In the first place there are numerous assurances throughout the Bible that God will look after His own children. God reveals Himself as the Shepherd to His flock and the Father to His children. He delights to turn apparent calamity into blessing and, though the path by which He leads His people is often very hard and unpleasant, He is leading them this way only in order to bring them in the right spirit into the promised land. At all stages of the history of the Jews, and equally in the New Testament, this confidence upheld His children and made them bold to face life and its perplexities, anxious only to do that which was right. Indeed, the problem of guidance as we know it seems rarely to have arisen, or at least rarely to have been prominent, because the men and women of God were preoccupied with obedience to God and beyond that they were able

神的引導

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奧利華·R·百其利

一 引導的事實

基督徒對可得神聖引導的事實少有存疑。首先整本聖經有許多確據說到神必會看顧屬祂的兒女。神啟示祂自己乃祂群羊的牧人，祂兒女的天父。祂樂於將顯然的災難變成為祝福。雖然祂引導祂百姓所走的路途常是艱辛和不快的，然而祂這樣引導不過為了帶領他們，叫他們以正確的態度進入應許之地。在猶太歷史的所有階段中，和在新約的所有階段中，這確信同樣地托起祂的兒女，使他們敢於面對生命和生命的窘局，只渴望作對的事情。據我們所認識，引導的問題似乎事實上少有被提起，也許最少是一直不大顯著，因為信神的男男女女都專心一致來順服神，在順服上，他們能信靠他

to trust their Lord to overrule.

Trust in the Lord, and do good; so you will dwell in the land, and enjoy security. Take delight in the Lord, and he will give you the desires of your heart. Commit your way to the Lord; trust in him, and he will act. (Psalm 37:3-5)

It is in this same confidence that we are assured that 'in everything God works for good with those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose' (Romans 8:28). That God really does overrule everything in the world and that even the wills of ungodly men are in His hands is an assurance which must form the background of all our thinking about guidance and will put our problems in their proper perspective.

In addition, we are given specific promises that the Lord will lead us. As He says to the psalmist (Psalm 32:8).

I will instruct you and teach you the way you should go; I will counsel you with my eye upon you.

Again, to a repentant and obedient people, He promises in Isaiah 58:11, '*the Lord will guide you continually*'.

們的主來掌管一切。

「你當倚靠耶和華而行善。住在地上，以祂的信實為糧。又要以耶和華為樂。祂就將你心裏所求的賜給你。當將你的事交託耶和華，並倚靠祂，祂就必成全。」（詩 37:3-5）

我們是以這相同的確信來確定「萬事都互相效力，叫愛神的人得益處，就是按祂旨意被召的人。」（羅8:28）也確信神真的掌管世上的一切，甚至那些不敬虔之人的意願也是在祂手中，這必然成為我們一切想到蒙引導之基礎的確據，也必會對我們的問題有正確的看法。

再者，主賜祂必帶領我們這特定的應許，正如祂向詩人說：

「我要教導你，指示你當行的路。我要定睛在你身上勸戒你。」（詩32:8）

祂在賽 58:11 也向悔改和順命的子民說：「耶和華也必時常引導你。」

Or, once more, we read in Proverbs 3:5, 6:

Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and do not rely on your insight. In all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make straight your paths.

(See also Psalm 25:8, 9, 12, etc.)

We are not promised guidance far ahead, nor are we assured that we shall always know how God is going to work; but we are promised that, as and when we need to make decisions, God will overrule and guide. Many Christians get into a quite unworthy state of anxiety over difficult decisions. This is often a failure of faith—not so much faith in particular promises as faith in God's providence. After all, God does know our problems, He does know our weakness and the incompleteness of our knowledge; He knows how soon a decision must be made; and, above all, He loves us. Is He not the Lord of hosts, the God of all the earth, who 'accomplishes all things according to the counsel of his will'? He promises to look after us and He certainly will do so; therefore—

Even though I walk through the

更且我們在箴3:5-6中讀到：

「你要專心仰賴耶和華，不可倚靠自己的聰明。在你一切所行的事上，都要認定祂，祂必指引你的路。」

(請也讀詩25:8, 9, 12。)

所應許我們的不是遠在前頭的引導，也不是我們常確知神如何工作；所應許我們的是因着和當我們需要來作出決定時，神必會掌權和引導。很多基督徒在困難決定上陷在完全不應有的憂慮狀態中。這常是沒有信心，尤其在相信神旨意的特定應許上沒太多信心。終究神真知道我們的困難，祂真知道我們的軟弱，和我們知識上的不完備；祂知道決定如何急逼；最要緊的是祂愛我們。祂不就是萬軍之耶和華，隨己意作萬事（弗1:11）那全地之神麼？祂應許看顧我們，祂也必然這樣。因此，

「雖然我行過死蔭

*valley of the shadow of death, I fear
no evil; for thou art with me.*

的幽谷，也不怕遭害，
因為祢與我同在。」

2 The method

There are many Christians, however, who, while they are in no doubt about the fact of guidance, are paralysed when confronted by difficult decisions, because they have no real idea how God guides. This is the main problem confronting us and it is here that it is particularly important to be sure that we are biblical in our thinking.

Some people point to the five or six major instances of entirely supernatural guidance in the New Testament and suggest that this is the normal method of guidance for the 'spiritual' Christian. An angel of the Lord spoke to Philip the evangelist telling him to go down to the desert where he met the Ethiopian eunuch (Acts 8:26). Peter had a vision guiding him to accept the invitation of Cornelius (Acts 10:1-23). The Holy Spirit spoke to the church at Antioch to send out Paul and Barnabas on the first great overseas missionary journey ever undertaken by Christians (Acts 13:1-3), and this was in confirmation of a personal vision

二 方法

可是有很多在神引導的事實上毫無懷疑的基督徒，當面對困難的抉擇時便嚇得木定口呆，因為他們在神的引導上沒有真正的概念。這是我們最主要要面對的問題。在這尤為重要的是我們確實要心中有聖經。

有人指着新約聖經中五六個完全超自然的引導事件，認為這是對「屬靈」基督徒的正常引導方法。有一個主的使者告訴傳福音的腓利下到曠野去迎見那埃提阿伯的太監（徒8:26）；有異象引導彼得接受哥尼流的邀請（徒10:1-23）；聖靈對安提阿的教會差派保羅和巴拿巴去進行基督徒所承擔的首個偉大海外宣教旅程（徒13:1-3），這成了早時給與保羅個人的認可異象（徒22:17-21）；保羅卻因另

given to Paul earlier (Acts 22:17-21). Paul crossed into Europe only after another vision (Acts 16:6-10).

These instances stand as testimony to the fact that God may guide in an altogether supernatural manner and this is no doubt as true today as it was then. If, however, this was intended to be the normal method of guidance for the Christian, why was it so rare and why are we nowhere in Scripture promised such supernatural leading? A wider study of the Acts and the Epistles makes it clear that, normally, the apostles were guided by ordinary decisions about the situation before them. The second and third missionary journeys were apparently undertaken simply because the converts needed help (Acts 15:36 and 18:23). When Paul wants to explain to the Corinthians why, instead of visiting them, he will spend the spring in Ephesus, he says that it is because 'a wide door for effective work has opened to me, and there are many adversaries', that is to say, because he is needed, and not because he 'felt led', or because of a vision.

It is, I believe, clear that the New

一個異象來越洋往歐洲而去（徒16:6-10）。

這些例子是作為「神以一完全超自然的手法來引導」這事實的證據，毫無疑問今天也如往昔般正確。但是，若這被基督徒認為是引導上的正常方法的話，那為甚麼這樣的超自然引導是那樣少見，且在聖經中沒有一處有這樣的應許呢？深入研究《使徒行傳》和新約書信便能弄清這個，使徒常以所面對的處境作為尋常決定的引導。承擔第二和第三次宣教旅程不過因為信徒需要幫助吧了（徒15:36；18:23）。當保羅想對哥林多人解說不能探望他們，反要在以弗所度過春天時，他說是「因為有寬大又有功效的門，為我開了，並且反對的人也多。」（林前16:9）即是說有人需要他，而不是因着他「蒙引導」，也不是因得見異象。

我相信新約基督徒

Testament Christians expected to be guided by 'wisdom', that is, by a sound judgment based on a truly Christian sense of values. Therefore they constantly consulted the apostles and the Old Testament Scriptures to discover what the heavenly wisdom dictated as a solution. Indeed it is this kind of guidance alone which is actually promised in the Bible, as we hope to show in the following pages. 'Wisdom' or 'judgment' is promised to us on certain conditions; and although God may, and sometimes does, guide in other ways, He nowhere promises to do so.

3 The Bible

The Lord is my shepherd, I shall not want; He makes me lie down in green pastures. He leads me beside still waters; He restores my soul. He leads me in paths of righteousness for his name's sake. (Psalm 23:1-3)

It is the last verse of this familiar quotation that is so often overlooked. 'He leads me in paths of righteousness.' This is always and everywhere true. No guidance that is not in a path of righteousness is from

期望得「智慧」的引導，明顯是基於真實基督徒價值觀的明智判斷。因此他們常時諮詢使徒和查舊約聖經，來尋找默寫為解決方法的屬天智慧。真的獨是這類型的引導是聖經實在應許的，正如我們希望在下文所顯示的。應許給我們的「智慧」和「判斷」是有某些條件的。雖然神也許和有時以別的方法來引導，但聖經從沒有一處是這樣應許的。

三 聖經

「耶和華是我的牧者。我必不至缺乏。祂使我躺臥在青草地上，領我在可安歇的水邊。祂使我的靈魂甦醒，為自己的名引導我走義路。」（詩23:1-3）

在這常引述經文末節中的「引導我走義路」常被忽略，卻何時何地都正確。神引導走的沒有一條不是義路，就是這原因為甚麼我們常被

God. This is why we are so constantly exhorted to search and to know the Bible if we want to be guided by God. If we neglect to discover what is God's clearly revealed will, or if, knowing it, we rely on other kinds of 'guidance', we shall not be in the line of God's leading.

There is an incident in the life of David (1 Samuel 24) which illustrates this most strikingly. David knew that God had rejected Saul the king and that he himself had been anointed to take his place. But Saul tried to kill him and chased him with an armed force into the wilderness. One day, when David and his men were hiding in the recesses of a cave, Saul came and paused to enter the cave alone. Thereupon David's men said in effect: 'Clearly this is God's overruling. He has now given you the means of fulfilling His plan—arise and kill him.' But David would not, for he said, 'I cannot do this thing and kill my enemy, seeing that he is the Lord's anointed.' It cost David probably several years of exile, being chased around the wilderness like a bandit. But he felt bound to do what was right although circumstances had been overruled so miraculously to

忠告，我們若想蒙神引導的話，便要搜查和認識聖經了。我們若拒絕來尋查神明明啟示的旨意，又或者在明知這個下仍去信賴別類的引導的話，那麼我們便不是與神的引導同步了。

在大衛的人生中（撒下24章）有一件事可顯著地說明這個。大衛知道神已廢棄掃羅作王，且膏他去取代其王位。掃羅卻力求殺他，用軍兵追趕他，逼他進入曠野。有一天，當大衛和他的人藏在山洞深處時，掃羅來到，獨自進入洞中。就此大衛的人實在說：「耶和華曾應許你說：我要將你的仇敵交在你手裏，你可以任意待他。如今時候到了。」（撒下24:4）但大衛不這樣作，說：「我在耶和華面前萬不敢伸手害他，因他是耶和華的受膏者。」可能大衛已逃亡了多年，在曠野像強盜般被追逐，雖則環境這樣奇妙地被管理，給他一個成就神

give him a short cut to fulfilling the Lord's will.

As if that wasn't enough the same thing happened again not long after, and David took Saul's spear and jar of water from beside him as he slept (1 Samuel 26:5-12). How easily David could have said, as Abishai in effect did, 'Circumstantial guidance! Clearly the Lord intends me to use this slightly doubtful method to accomplish His will.' But it was David who wrote the twenty-third Psalm.

In 2 Timothy 3:16, 17, where we are told of the inspiration and purpose of Scripture, we sometimes forget that the uses of Scripture which are mentioned include: 'for correction, and for training in righteousness, that the man of God may be complete, equipped for every good work.' It is clear that, in reading the Bible, we ought constantly to seek practical, ethical instruction; and it is often ignorance of the Bible in this sense that is responsible for wrong choice.

Certain things are explicitly forbidden in Scriptures, and in such cases obedience, not guidance, is required. The man or woman who professes to be guided to marry a

旨意的捷徑，但他感到有必要作對的事。

不久之後，一件不盡相同的事情再次發生，當掃羅沉睡時，大衛取走了他身旁的槍和水瓶。（撒下26:5-12）大衛大抵可如亞比篩所說「何等環境上的引導！明顯耶和華想我們用這稍微存疑的方法來成就祂的旨意。」但寫詩23篇的就是這大衛。

提後3:16-17告訴我們聖經的靈感和功用，我們有時忘記了其中提及「使人歸正，教導人學義，叫屬神的人得以完全，預備行各樣的善事。」的聖經用途。明顯在讀經時，我們該常常尋求實際和合乎道德的指引，這也是常常忽略了聖經是為了明辨錯誤的選擇而存在的。

有些事情是聖經明確禁止的，這情況下所需要的是順服而非引導。例如那些宣稱蒙引導與非基督徒結婚的男

non-Christian, for instance, is talking nonsense. It is explicitly forbidden again and again in the Old Testament and implicitly, and quite clearly so, on several occasions in the New. Dishonesty, lying, immorality, snobbishness, selfishness and a whole host of other things are so clearly pointed out in the Bible that we cannot possibly claim to be guided to indulge in them, however excellent we hope the final result may be, and however strikingly other factors seem to have pointed to such a course of action. But this does not mean that there is a verse in the Bible for every choice. Neither does it mean that an apparently relevant phrase in the Bible (or in a hymn or Daily Light) settles the matter. The devil quoted Scripture to Jesus Christ in His temptation and he may quote it to us, though he nearly always distorts its meaning. We must be sure that we have really understood what the passage concerned means and what it really asks of us on the moral level.

Some people constantly look for guidance in the form of a special verse of Scripture being 'given to them'. We are never promised this, and it has sometimes led to absurd actions. The

女是大放厥詞。舊約聖經中這一次又一次明確禁止，而新約聖經中的某些處境雖並非直接，也十分清楚是這樣的。不忠、說謊、不道德、勢利、自私和大量別的事情是聖經極清楚指明是我們不可能宣稱蒙引導來縱情其中的。可歎我們雖這樣極力盼望，最終卻事與願違；並且明顯有別些因素似乎被指是導至那些行為的。這不是說在任何選擇上都有着聖經經文支持。這也不是說在聖經中有似乎相關的經節（或聖詩、或《聖光日引》的經文）能解決那問題。魔鬼在耶穌基督的試探中也引用聖經。他會向我們引述，幾乎總扭曲經文本義。我們須確定的是要真知道經文的相關意思，並它在道德層面上真正要求我們的。

有人常從「所給與他們」的特別聖經經節的形式來尋求引導。神從沒有應許這個，這曾帶來荒誕的行徑。被分

missionary candidate allocated to Egypt was right to ignore the fact that in his daily Bible reading he constantly met phrases such as 'do not go to Egypt', because the meaning of the prohibition was the important thing, not the literal sense when taken out of its context.

On the other hand, as we pray and search our Bible for guidance we may well find some ethical truth or commandment of a general nature which exactly fits our case. The speaker, endeavouring to cancel an engagement previously agreed to, was right to agree to go after all when he happened to read Psalm 15 and found: 'Who shall dwell on the holy hill? He ... who swears to his own hurt and does not change.' But this was a principle that should have been taken into account beforehand.

Most of our difficult decisions, however, do not concern anything dealt with directly in the Bible. The primary essential, in these cases, is a truly Christian sense of values, and this we acquire only as our thinking is increasingly moulded by the Bible. We are naturally selfish and we are extraordinarily clever in justifying whatever we want to do. Therefore

配到埃及去的宣教申請者不理會他們每天讀經中經常讀到例如「不要下埃及去」的經文這事實是正確的，因為那禁止所指的是那自高自大的事，而不是斷章取義下按字面意思去行。

另一方面，當我們禱告和尋查聖經來得引導時，我們總能找到一些性質和道德上大抵正切合情況的真理或誡命。有與某人訂婚的人讀到詩15篇時，發現「誰能住在你的聖山？就是行為正直，作事公義，心裏說實話的人。」(詩15:1-2)後便極力取消先前訂立的婚約。但這原則是事先該已考慮到的。

但是我們大部分的困難決定是沒有聖經直接論及的。在這些情況下，至重要的是真實的基督徒價值觀，我們所需的的就是我們的思想要越發為聖經所塑造。我們本性是利己的，合理化所想作的任何事上是絕頂聰明的。因此蒙引

the first step in guidance is to seek to have a right estimate of the situation. We shall often need a truly Christian attitude to money and to reputation, for instance. Many difficult decisions resolve themselves into a question of how far we do right to spend money on ourselves, or how much attention we should pay to our own reputation or 'position' in society.

'He leads me in paths of righteousness for his name's sake', says David, and we must learn to judge what is most for the honour of His name in every situation, and to let that be the most important factor. This is not something that comes to us naturally or easily. It is the fruit of a life constantly reprov'd and corrected by Scripture and lived in close fellowship with and obedience to God.

4 Wisdom and common sense

If any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask God who gives to all men generously and without reproaching, and it will be given him. But let him ask in faith, with no doubting. (James 1:5-6)

During persecution there are

導的第一步就是要尋求在實況上有正確的估量。例如在金錢和名譽上我們常需要有正確的基督徒態度。很多困難的決定當被看成為例如我們在花費金錢上如何作得對，又或者我們在社會上一己的名譽或地位要多少關注的一個問題而得到解決。

大衛說「祂為自己的名引導我走義路。」我們定須學會如何判斷在每個處境中祂的名如何得着最大的榮耀，也學曉這就是最重要的因素。這不是一些自然和輕易臨到我們的東西，這是常被聖經責備和改正，並活在與神緊密相交和順服神之生活中人的果子。

四 智慧和常理

「你們中間若有缺少智慧的，應當求那厚賜與眾人，也不斥責人的神，主就必賜給他。只要憑着信心求，一點不疑惑。」（雅1:5-6）

受逼迫期間有着很

many difficult decisions and it is very hard to keep a right attitude to the oppressor (1:9-12) or to the present trials (1:12-18), therefore we need special wisdom and must pray for it.

When we find ourselves in perplexity we are instructed to ask for wisdom and we are assured that we shall be given it; but the question arises as to what exactly this wisdom is. Some have called it 'sanctified common sense', but this can be most misleading. In James 3:13-18 the matter is discussed further and it is pointed out that there is an earthly wisdom and a heavenly wisdom and that the two are often contrary. The heavenly wisdom is seen in a pure and gracious Christian attitude to people and things. It is the faculty that enables us to steer our way through life in a manner consistent with Christian character. What is promised to us, therefore, is the grace to look at things in a Christian way and to discern what we ought to do accordingly. Often this is at variance with what is called common sense. From the point of view of common sense it is nearly always foolish to

多困難的決定，且十分艱難來向壓逼者（雅1:9-12）或在面對試煉（雅1:12-18）時保持正確的態度，因此我們需要特別的智慧和定須為此禱告。

當我們發現陷於窘境中時，我們蒙教導來祈求智慧，且有必得賜這智慧的保證。但立時冒起的問題是這智慧實在是甚麼來的。有人稱它為「聖化的常理」，但這是極之誤導的。雅3:13-18對此有進一步的討論，並指出有的是地上的智慧和天上的智慧，並且兩者總是相違背的。**在人事物上有純潔和愛心取態的基督徒得見屬天的智慧。**這機能使我們能夠在我們人生中以基督徒品格一致的態度來前行。因此所應許我們的是蒙恩得以基督徒的方式來看事物，因而辨識我們所當作的。這常與我們號稱的常理大相逕庭。以常理的觀點來看，踏進事奉，或到海外宣教，或

enter the ministry, or to go abroad as a missionary, or to turn the other cheek. It is only heavenly wisdom which considers the real needs of men, and it is only a mind moulded by the Bible which is able, in adversity, to look beyond this world to see the things that are unseen and eternal (see James 1:2-4, 9-12).

Here, therefore, we are promised that if we come, humbly recognizing our incompetence, and ask in faith, we shall be given the ability to discern what is the right thing to do. This will not come to us in some magical way, nor will it relieve us of the duty of careful calculation. The promise is that we shall be enabled to look at the problem 'Christianly'. In choosing a career, for instance, the Christian will have a completely different standard of values from the non-Christian, and it is the matter of our whole scale of values that the divine wisdom is most commonly distinguished from worldly wisdom. Or again, to take the actual examples given in James 3, if we have been wronged or insulted by someone else, common sense often dictates that we should 'teach them a lesson', or 'clear our own character',

轉過臉來由得人打幾乎總是愚蠢的。惟有屬天的智慧會考慮到真正的需要，惟有被聖經所模造的心思能夠相反地越過世界來看不可見和永恒的事物。（參看雅 1:2-4；9-12）

因此，所應許我們的是，當我們謙卑來承認我們的無能，並用信來祈求時，我們必得賜能力來辨識甚麼是當作之事。這不會以一神奇的方式臨到，它也必不會叫我們脫離那小心計算下給我們的責任。所應許的是我們必能基督化地看問題。例如，在選擇職業上，基督徒與非基督徒有着完全不同的價值標準，這是我們的整個價值標準與屬世智慧有着最常有分別的問題。再者，據雅3章的實際例子來看，我們若被人惡待或羞辱時，常有的常理會叫我們「教訓他們一頓」，或「在我們一己的品格上作出澄清」，或「揭露他們

or 'expose their real motives', etc. The wisdom that is from above, on the other hand, 'is first pure (i.e. concerned with what is right, holy and true), then peaceable, gentle, open to reason, full of mercy ...' etc. Such an attitude and way of looking at things is likely to lead to an opposite policy. In the manner of an unhappy home, for example, the Christian wisdom clearly indicates a determination at all costs to learn to live together and get on together and love one another more truly, however difficult that may be, while the world's wisdom will comparatively quickly give up and seek in divorce an easier ('common sense') way out.

There is an instructive example in Acts 6. The church was faced with certain administrative difficulties and the problem was solved by seeking out seven men and putting them in charge of the matter. The grounds for such a solution were simply: 'It is not right that we should give up preaching the word of God to serve tables ... and what they said pleased the whole multitude.' Further, the qualifications of these men were to be three (verse 3): they were to be men of good reputation, 'full of the Spirit and of

真正的動機」等；從上頭來的智慧卻「先是清潔（即是關乎到對錯、聖潔和真偽的），後是和平、溫柔、對理性持開放態度、滿是憐憫」（雅3:17）等。這樣看事物的態度和方法極可能帶來截然不同的方針。舉一個例，無論如何困難，在一個不快家庭中，基督徒的智慧會清晰表明決意付上一切代價來一起生活，且更真誠地彼此相愛；而屬世的智慧必是相對快地放棄，尋求離婚來得着較輕鬆（常理）的解脫。

在徒6章中有着一指導性的例子。教會面對某些行政上的問題，藉着設立七人來負責那事而得解決。這解法方法的理據是簡單的：「我們撇下神的道去管理飯食原是不合宜的.....大眾都喜悅這話。」（徒6:2, 6）更且，這些人的資格有三（徒6:3）：他們要有好名聲、被**聖靈充滿**和**智慧充足**。即是說，他們是

wisdom'. That is to say, they were to be men who command the confidence of all concerned and who were not only very 'heavenly minded' but men who had shown a gift for applying a heavenly mind to down-to-earth problems. Some Christians show this gift more than others, but we are all invited to seek it as a gift from God and to steer our way through life, not by irrational hunches, but by the application of revealed truth to real situations. It is only in this sense that we can speak of 'sanctified common sense'. We must use our ordinary faculties to weight up a situation and to reach a decision; but our whole outlook on life must be Christian and not at all 'common' before we start work. We are so extraordinarily adept at thinking out reasons to justify whatever we want to do that it is essential that we should make sure that, all along the line, our standards and criteria have been truly scriptural.

5 Judgment

He leads the humble in what is right, and teaches the humble his way. Who is the man that fears the Lord? Him will he instruct in the way

得着所有相關人士信心的人，他們不單止有着十分「屬天的心思」，且顯示出他們有着將屬天頭腦應用在地上問題的恩賜。有一些基督徒顯出這恩賜比別人多，但我們全都被邀尋求作為從神來的恩賜來在人生中前行，不是靠不理性的直覺，而是將所啟示的真理應用在實際處境上。惟有這樣我們才能說用上「聖化的常理」。我們必須用上普通機能來衡量處境，來達至決定，但在我們開始工作之先，我們生命的整個外觀必須是基督徒的，毫不「尋常」的。我們是超凡地擅於想出理由來合理化我們所作任何要作的事，因此重要的是我們要自始至終確定我們的標準和準則一直都真的合乎聖經。

五 判斷

「祂必按公平引領謙卑人，將祂的道教訓他們。.....誰敬畏耶和華，耶和華必指示他當

that he should choose. My eyes are ever toward the Lord, for he will pluck my feet out of the net. (Psalm 25:9, 12, 15)

In the last resort we have to make up our minds. God's promise is that He will lead us in our decisions if, on our part, we are open to His leading and control. The whole of Psalm 25 should be studied for some of the conditions of guidance. When we have prayerfully sought to judge the matter in the light of the heavenly wisdom, and searched the Scriptures for principles bearing on the matter and to ensure that, as far as we know, we are not being ruled by false motives; then we have to make a decision and keep to it. Some people spend hours, and even years, going back over decisions they have made in the past, trying to make up their minds whether they were right or not. But we are to ask for wisdom 'in faith, with no doubting' and we are promised that we shall know 'what is right' or, as the AV has it, 'the meek will he guide in judgment'. This going back over the ground is really doubting the truth of God's promises.

Looking back we often feel that

選擇的道路。.....我的眼目時常仰望耶和華。因為祂必將我的腳從網裏拉出來。」(詩25:9, 12, 15)

最終我們要作出自己的決定。神應許祂必會在我們的決定上引導，只要我們在被引導和管治上持開放的態度。整篇詩25篇該作為引導的條件來研究。當我們祈禱尋求以屬天智慧的光來判斷事情，並在聖經中搜查那事情的原則時，照我們所知，確實的是我們不會被錯誤的動機所左右，這樣我們便可作出和忠於決定。有人以小時計，甚至年計的時間來在他們過去所作的決定上反反覆覆，盡力來在心中有對或錯的定奪；我們要「一無掛慮下用信」來祈求智慧，所應許的是我們必知「甚麼是對」，或如美譯本所說「祂必按公平引領謙卑人」(詩25:9)。反覆的人其實懷疑神應許的真實性。

回顧時常感到我們

our decisions were not based on all the facts we might have known. But God gives us sufficient information for a decision if we seek it where we are told to look, and we can trust Him to guide us by giving us, or withholding from us, the facts which would determine our judgment. It is not that, in the light of all the facts, we know afterwards that the decision seems right. The promise is that at the time He will overrule our judgment so that our decisions are in accordance with His will.

Let us suppose, by way of illustration, that you have to stay on at the university an extra year and do an education diploma. There are an enormous number of possible arguments for or against, some depending upon a future which at present you cannot foresee. God alone foresees that future. We could ask for a 'hunch' to settle the matter irrationally, in which case we shall probably be in a state of constant anxiety lest we have not got the right hunch. Alternatively we can, more scripturally, try to weigh up all the factors which we do understand and can foresee and then make a decision trusting God to overrule our decision

的決定不是基於已知的所有事實。神給我們足夠的資料作決定，只要我們朝告訴我們仰望之處去尋求，便能信靠祂藉給或不給這事實來作為我們判斷的引導。在所有事實的光中來看，實情並非這樣，我們事後會知道這決定似乎是對的。所應許的是祂必掌管我們那時作的決定，因此我們的決定便與祂的旨意一致。

讓我們舉一個例子來說明。假設你要在大學多讀一年完成一個教育文憑。支持和反對的可能論點鋪天蓋地，有些是因着你如今不可逆料的未來。獨有神能預見未來。我們可祈求一個「預感」來非理性地處理那問題，我們若得不着正確預感的話，我們可能必會落在恆常的憂慮中。我們也可更按照聖經來盡力衡量我們所能明白和預見的一切因素，之後按神會掌管我們作出正確決定的信靠下來作出決定。你也

aright. You may find later that some of the arguments which determined your choice turned out to have been false (e.g. your health unexpectedly prevented your going abroad), but that does not alter the fact that God overruled your decision and gave you sufficient reasons for the policy that He wanted you to follow and withheld from you any overwhelming reasons against it. He led you in knowing what was right.

Some people become seriously worried about their guidance in the trivial matter of daily conduct. They feel, for example, that it might be vitally important which way they walk round a block of buildings to get to the college. And they are right, of course; it might be. But they go on from that to a state of constant anxiety and concern lest they do the wrong thing. Sometimes they start one way and have a 'feeling', after praying about it, that they ought to go back and go the other. But if these promises about wisdom and judgment are true, we have no right to be anxious and worried like this. We would decide which is the shortest route and which involves least traffic hazards (no Christian has

許不久會發現決定你選擇的一些論據到頭來是錯誤的（例如你的健康在猜想不到的情況下阻止你出國），但這沒有改變神掌管你決定這事實，且在祂想你要跟從的方向上給你足夠的理據，並抑制那些與這方向背道而馳排山倒海的理據。祂引導你來認識甚麼是對的。

有人在他們日常行止的瑣碎事項的引導上極度擔憂。例如他們感到繞過大廈來到達學院所走哪一條路是至為重要的。但他們為免行差踏錯進而來到某種恆常憂慮和擔心的狀態。有時他們開始時按一「感覺」而走某個方向，為這禱告之後，他們卻以為該回頭走另一條路。若這些在智慧和判斷上的應許是真的話，我們便無權有像這樣的擔憂和掛慮。我們會決定走那最便捷的路徑，這涉及最少的交通事故（沒有基督徒有權浪費時間或冒沒需要的生命和肢

a right to waste time or to risk life and limb needlessly!), and we shall decide to go that way. If the Lord really wants us to go the other way tomorrow, in order to meet someone, we can believe that He will give us a reason for doing so (I remember that I need a new note-book and the best stationers is round there. etc.). We must believe in God's promises and in His providence, and then we can go about our daily work calmly trusting Him to overrule our decisions. There is no moral right and wrong about these trivial decisions, and they should be settled by the most matter-of-fact considerations. It is wrong only if we are consciously disobedient to a clear duty. Where there is nothing to choose between two courses, we can, if we like, vary what we do just for the sake of a change.

Even after apparently miraculous guidance we have to make a firm decision, as Paul did after the vision of the man from Macedonia (Acts 16:10). Indeed, the normal guidance in the New Testament seems to have been a matter of clear decisions based upon evidence (e.g. Acts 6:2-5; 11:28-29; 15:14-22, 25; 16:3; 30:3, 16;

體危險！)，便決定往那方向走。主若真的想我們明天走另一條路，為要遇見某人時，我們可相信祂必會給我們作這個的原因。（我憶及我需要一部新的筆記簿，而那最好的文具店就在轉角那兒等等。）我們定須相信神的應許和眷顧，我們便能鎮定地作每天的工作，信靠祂掌管我們的決定。在我們這些瑣碎決定上是沒有道德上之對錯的，他們也該按最事實性的考慮來得解決。惟有我們故意在清晰的責任上不順服才是錯的。那兒沒有兩個選項，只要我們喜歡，我們可因着想轉換之故來作出改動。

那怕決定是在我們明顯非凡的引導下毅然作出的，如同保羅得見馬其頓異象所作的一樣（徒16:10），但新約聖經中尋常的引導似乎一向都基於事實而作明確決定。（例如：徒6:1-5；11:28-29；15:14-22, 25；

1 Corinthians 16:8-9). Our difficulty today is partly that we hate making up our minds and we always go on hoping for events to push us into one course of action or another. The Lord does not always allow us to see far ahead but we must constantly make decisions and we must learn to do so in a biblical way in small things if we hope to be able to do so in the big ones.

In practice this means that we must often seek out relevant facts. If we are thinking of being a deaconess we must try to discover what the work involves. If we are trying to choose a speaker for our Christian Union we may have to go to some trouble to obtain opinions about speakers from those who know them. When we believe we have sufficient facts, we must decide. We shall never have all the facts that are relevant but we can expect to be led in our decisions when we are adequately informed. It is not more spiritual to keep on postponing decisions in order to pray about them in the hope of getting a 'hunch'. Many people, who wonder whether they are being called to foreign missionary service, remain in uncertainty and doubt partly

16:3 ; 30:3, 16 ; 林前 16:8-9)我們今天的問題部分是因為我們不愛立定心意，我們也常盼望有事情發生將我們推向一個方向。主不常容讓我們看得久遠，我們卻定須恆常作出決定，我們若盼望能在大事上按聖經而行，便定須學習在小事上也是這樣。

實際上我們必須常尋查相關的事實。我們若想成為一名女執事，就定須盡力尋查所包括的工作。我們若要為我們的基督教聯會選擇一名講員，在想從那些認識講員的人中獲取意見上也許遇上一些困難。當我們相信我們有着足夠的事實時，我們便須下決定。我們永不能得着所有相關的事實，但當我們有着足夠的資料提供，便可期待必會在決定上蒙引導。為着決定而禱告，盼望得着「預感」而仍在下決定上猶豫不是更屬靈。很多不知他們是否被呼召往外國作宣教服事的人依然

because they have never troubled to discover what the needs and opportunities of the mission field are. If they knew the facts better they could judge whether they were able to meet the needs.

6 Advice

The way of a fool is right in his own eyes. But a wise man listens to advice. (Proverbs 12:15)

Listen to advice and accept instruction, That you may gain wisdom for the future. (Proverbs 19:20)

The Bible is far from despising the wisdom that comes with experience of life and of God's dealings with men. In fact there is a repeated emphasis upon the need for being humble enough to consult other and in particular those with a longer experience. Rehoboam was typical of 'youth', and was at fault when he despised the counsel of the older men and followed only the advice of his contemporaries (1 Kings 12). Further, as Proverbs 12:15 reminds us, it is a characteristic of fools to be content with their own opinion, while the truly wise will listen to, and therefore

在不肯定和疑慮中，部分原因是他們從未費神來尋查宣教禾場的需要和機遇。只要他們更認清真相，便能衡量他們能否符合那些需要。

六 聽勸

「愚妄人所行的，在自己眼中看為正直；惟智慧人，肯聽人的勸教。」（箴12:15）

「你要聽勸教，受訓誨，使你終久有智慧。」（箴19:20）

聖經決不輕視來自人生經驗和與神交往之人的智慧。事實上聖經中重覆地強調要有足夠的謙卑來諮詢別人，尤其是那些有長久經驗之人。羅波安是典型的少年人，在輕視老年人的勸導，只遵從同歲之人的意見上出錯（王上12章）。再者，箴12:15提醒我們，愚妄人的特徵就在自己的意見上滿意；而真正的智慧人肯去聆聽，因而必能尋見可得着的最智慧建議。

must seek out, the wisest advice available.

Many Christians err here. They seem to be unwilling to humble themselves so far as to admit that an older Christian may have a much better grasp of the heavenly wisdom than they do. But there are people who know the Bible better, know human nature better and can judge our gifts and limitations more impartially than we can ourselves. This is not to say that we should be under bondage to obey our elders and betters. There are real dangers here, and no-one else can get guidance for us (see 1 Kings 13). Nevertheless it is doubtful whether anyone should make a major decision in life, such as what career he should follow, without getting the advice of some experienced Christian. Many young married couples, for instance, confronted with problem in their marriage, are too proud to consult experienced and wise people and have only themselves to blame for prolonged difficulties and even ultimate disaster. It is interesting that Paul, who had refused to follow advice not to go to Jerusalem because he believed it was his duty to go,

很多基督徒就在這裏出錯。他們似乎不願意謙卑自己，不肯承認一個較年長的基督徒可能在屬天智慧上比他們有着更多的掌握。有人更認識聖經，他們更認識人性，且比我們自己更能無偏見地判斷我們的恩賜和限制。這不是說我們是要屈從來順服我們的長者和長輩。這裏存在着真正的危險，總沒有人能代替我們來得着引導的（參看王上13章）。不過，任何人應否在沒有得着一些有經驗之基督徒的建議下來作出例如我們當有甚麼職業這等人生重大決定上是存疑的。舉一個例，很多年輕夫婦在婚姻上面對疑難，雙方都太傲慢，不諮詢有經驗之人和智者，使他們為着這拖延的問題和甚至終極的災禍而承受責任。有趣的是，保羅拒絕聽從不上耶路撒冷的建議，是因他相信上去

nevertheless was willing to obey implicitly the advice given by the elders of the church in Jerusalem (Acts 21:17-26), presumably because they knew the situation in the city better than he did, and no question of moral duty was involved.

It was fashionable at one stage for students to give up their university courses halfway in order to go out to the mission field. But these same people, as well as other older Christians, would now certainly advise students first to finish their degrees.

The enthusiasm and self-sacrifice involved were admirable, but any older man can see that it is better to give 28 years of first-class missionary service than 30 years of second-class usefulness. For, quite apart from the value of having a degree, the youthful enthusiast may need the mental discipline of a strenuous course to help him to be a clearer thinker, a better linguist and a man who knows how to spend his time. And there are many other factors involved which only older people are likely to be able to weigh up fully. That is why missionary societies have committees, and churches have selection boards for candidates for the ministry; and

是他的責任，卻仍樂意在耶路撒冷的教會領袖所給的建議上絕對順服（徒21:17-26），大抵是因他們比他更認識城中的處境，其中是不涉及道德責任等問題的。

對於學生要半路中途放棄讀大學來到宣教禾場去某程度上是時興的。但這些相同的人，加上別些年長的基督徒如今肯定會提議學生們先完成他們的學位。

熱誠和自我犧牲是可景仰的，但任何年長的人能見到提供二十八年的優等宣教服事勝於三十年次等的幫助。且莫說一個學位的價值，年輕的熱心人也許需要一個努力課程的精神訓練來幫助他成為更清晰的思想家、更佳的語言學家和認識如何利用時間的人。有很多其他牽涉的因素似乎只有較年長之人能夠全面衡量得到。就是這原因為何宣教組織有其委員會，而眾教會有着宣教工作候選人的鄰選委員會；這

the decisions of such bodies are not to be treated lightly, though they are certainly not always the voice of God.

7 Signs

Then Gideon said to God, 'If thou wilt deliver Israel by my hand, as thou hast said, behold I am laying a fleece of wool on the threshing floor; if there is dew on the fleece alone, and it is dry on all the ground, then I shall know that thou wilt deliver Israel by my hand, as thou hast said.' (Judges 6:36-37)

Gideon's fleece and a number of similar signs in the Old Testament, together with the few visions and supernatural guidances mentioned in the New Testament, have led some people to believe that they have a right to ask of God a sign, or to expect some peculiar personal revelation, before they make any important decision. But this is a pure assumption. Nowhere are we encouraged to imitate Gideon, and the signs seem to have been given him, firstly, because he had no Bible to guide him (or very little of it), and secondly, because he was so unspiritual as to need such signs to bolster up his faith in the definite

些組織的決定不是輕率作出的，雖然他們肯定不常是神的聲音。

七 異兆

「基甸對神說：祢若果照着所說的話，藉我手拯救以色列人，我就把一團羊毛放在禾場上，若單是羊毛上有露水，別的地方都是乾的，我就知道祢必照着所說的話，藉我手拯救以色列人。」(士6:36-37)

基甸的羊毛團和舊約中幾個相似的異兆，加上在新約中提及的幾個異象和超然的引導事例，叫一些人們相信他們在作出任何重大決定之先，有權來要求神給與一個異兆，或期望一些特別的個人啟示。但這是一個純粹的假設。從沒有一處聖經鼓勵我們來模仿基甸，而之所以給與他異兆，似乎先是因為他沒有聖經的引導（或只有十分少的聖經），並且因為他不是那樣屬靈，因此「如你所說」需要這樣的異兆

promises which God had already given ('as thou hast said'). In the New Testament no such signs are recorded as were from time to time given to people like Gideon in the Old Testament. The supernatural guidances mentioned in the New Testament are almost all in cases where the guidance given was in order to enlarge their understanding of Scripture (Peter and Cornelius) or contrary to what appeared reasonable (Philip and the eunuch, Paul and Macedonia). They are mostly over issues that were crucial for the future of the church in a way that is probably hardly ever true of decisions today. If they were intended to be a model for us to follow, the fact would surely have been stated, and the Epistles would have contained some evidence on the subject.

Throughout church history there have been people who have justified the most fantastic and even un-Christian deeds (and doctrines) on the grounds of some special vision or sign. And today missionary opportunities have sometimes been neglected in defiance of the clearest wisdom; people have refused to go to posts where they are clearly needed,

來增強他對神早已給與他確實應許的信，在新約聖經中沒有如同在舊約中時不時給與像基甸這等人這樣異兆的記錄。新約中超自然的引導幾乎全是因着要加強他們對聖經的認識而給與引導的（彼得和哥尼流），或與那些看為合理之事相違背時（腓利和太監，保羅和馬其頓人）。大部分這些事件於教會的未來是極為重要的，今天要下這決定可能是艱難的。若有意以他們作為我們要遵行的模範時，這事實必然會說明，使徒也會在這題目上加上一些證據。

在整個教會歷史中，曾有人在最難以相信，甚至非基督徒的行徑上，因着一些特別的異象和異兆來證明有理。而今天宣教的良機有時因着蔑視最清晰的智慧而有所忽略。人們拒絕就任明明需要他們的崗位，並且基督徒因

and Christians have indulged in the grossed folly, on the grounds that they had no sign to reassure them, or that some supposed sign justified an obviously foolish and even unscriptural course of action.

This is not to say that, as a concession to our lack of understanding and lack of ability to discern God's will, He does not sometimes graciously give such guidance. But we are nowhere encouraged to ask for a sign, and we must always test such peculiar experiences by the true wisdom. For the devil can give signs also; and, particularly with people who are psychologically unstable, he often does give visions and hunches which lead them into error or foolishness which is used to disgrace the gospel. Indeed, it is probably true that, in the majority of cases today where people claim guidance by such means, the so-called signs turn out not to have been of divine origin, and in every case they are difficult to interpret. A New Testament illustration is supplied by Paul's last visit to Jerusalem. The fact that in every place he visited Paul was warned, sometimes by means of visions and prophecies (Acts 20:22-24;

為他們得不着叫他們安心的異兆而沉溺於嚴重的罪行中；又或者有人以一些所謂的異兆作為他們愚蠢甚至不符合聖經之行徑的合理證據。

這不是說因着我們在神的旨意上缺乏認識和識別能力，神便有時不施恩來給與引導。聖經沒有一處鼓勵我們來祈求異兆，我們總定必以真實的智慧來檢驗這樣特別的經驗，因為魔鬼也能給與異兆，尤其那些心理不穩定的人，他常給與異象和預感來引導他們作錯誤或愚蠢的行為，來叫福音蒙羞。在今天絕大多數的例子中人們宣稱得着這樣的引導，那所謂異兆的引導也許到頭來事實證明並非有着神聖本源，每個事例上他們都難以解說。保羅最後一次上耶路撒冷是新約提供的一個說明事例。保羅每到的一個地方事實都收到警告，有時藉異象，有時藉預言（徒 20:22-24；21:10-12），

21:10-12), that 'imprisonment and afflictions' awaited him did not deter him from going, in order to fulfil his clear duty (at least in part to hand over to the 'poor saints in Jerusalem' the money raised for their relief by the churches of Europe). It is also worth noting that his duty overruled the almost universal requests of his friends. If we had been in Paul's place and to the requests of our friends had been added supernatural warnings (in this case apparently of divine origin) most of us would have been overawed into changing our plans; but not so Paul. It is not clear why these signs were given, unless it was to prepare Paul and the churches for the apparent catastrophe of his imprisonment and to reassure them, after the event, that it was part of God's will. In any case they were evidently not to be interpreted as guidance that he should alter his plan.

8 Feelings

Was I vacillating when I wanted to do this? Do I make my plans like a worldly man, ready to say Yes and No at once? (2 Corinthians 1:17)

In spite of all that has been said,

就是等待着他的「捆鎖與患難」也不能阻止他行完他的路程，成就他清晰的職事（部分原因最少是要將歐洲教會所籌集的捐項交到耶路撒冷窮苦的聖徒手中）。他的職責壓倒他朋友們幾乎一致的請求也不算甚麼。我們若取上保羅的位置，得着朋友的請求，加上（這事例中明顯是有着神聖本源）超自然的警告時，我們大多數人會畏縮而改變計劃，保羅卻不是這樣。我們不清楚為何要賜下這些異兆，除非是來預備保羅得知他被囚的明顯災禍和叫教會在事情之後得安心，這是部分神的旨意。在任何情況下他們明顯不被看為他會改變他計劃的引導。

八 感覺

「我有此意，豈是反覆不定麼？我所起的意思，豈是從情慾起的，叫我忽是忽非麼？」(林後1:17)

但有人不理會所說

however, it may be argued that surely the Lord will give an inward feeling that we are doing right and, if we have that, it should not be necessary to bother about these other means of guidance. The first answer is that, although the Lord often does give such feelings, He nowhere in the Bible promises them, and He often asks His children to act, even in important matters, without them. Secondly, such inward assurances are notoriously misleading, especially when the problem involves something which we very much want to do. Thirdly, even when they lead us in the right direction, such feelings are usually changeable and to some extent at the mercy of our health.

Most people become depressed and introspective when they are tired, but quickly recover with some good food and extra sleep. There are people whose feelings are so unstable that they indicate constant changes of direction. To such people one can only say that there is no clearer evidence that their feelings must be ignored. We are to find our 'joy and peace in believing', not in feeling.

The apostles showed this independence of feelings by

的這一切，仍爭論說主必會在我們作得對上給與一外在感覺。我們若有這個，便不需煩惱別些引導的方法了。對這的答案是：一、主雖常給與這樣的感覺，但沒有一處聖經應許這個。祂常叫祂的兒女來在沒有感覺下來有所行動，甚或在重大的事情上。二，這樣裏面確據的誤導是惡名昭著的，尤其當問題涉及他們十分想作之事時。三，就算這些感覺引導我們往正確方向走，感覺大都常隨我們的健康而變動。大部分人當他們疲倦時都會變得沮喪和內省，吃一些好食物和作出額外休息後他們很快便會復原。有人的感覺是那樣的穩定，因此他們顯出方向上恆常的改變。人只可對這樣的人說，沒有比他們的感覺是可置諸不理更明顯。**我們是因着相信而不是感覺來得着喜樂和平安的。**

使徒們在勇往直前上顯示其不倚靠感覺。

constantly planning ahead. They 'purposed' to do something and set about it, while recognizing at the same time that God might order things so that their purposes could not be fulfilled (e.g. 1 Corinthians 16:8-9; 2 Corinthians 1:15-24; Acts 15:36; 16:6-10). In 2 Corinthians 1 Paul is chiefly arguing to defend himself against a charge of changeableness, which he agrees would be quite unfitting for a Christian. His reply is that he had powerful reasons for altering his plans. New facts had come to light; the situation had been drastically altered and, in the light of the new facts, he could no longer fulfil the original purpose of a visit. He gives good sound reasons for his actions. He never says that he 'felt led'. And yet some people say that it is 'unspiritual' to plan ahead!

This is not to say that feelings can be entirely ignored. When we feel unhappy about a course of action it must head us to think it through again and to make sure that we are not doing wrong. For it is most often when matters of right and wrong are concerned that feelings come in. A business dealing that is not actually dishonest may leave us feeling so

他們是按所定目標來作事的，朝這進發，同時認識到神可能會來命令事物叫他們的目標得以達成的（例如林前16:8-9；林後1:15-24；徒15:36；16:6-10）。在林後1章中，保羅主要在他被指控易變上來自辯，他同意這於基督徒是極不適切的。他答覆說他有着強而有力的原因來改變計劃。新的事實呈現，處境有着徹底的改變，因着嶄新事實的呈現，他不再要達成他原本的行程目標。在他的行動上他給與可靠的原因。他從沒有說到他「感到被引導」，然而有人說這樣的事先的計劃是「不屬靈」的！

這不是說感覺可完全被忽略。當我們在某個行動上感到不快時，這必會領我們一次又一次想到要確定我們不走錯。因為最常見到當關注的是事件的對錯時，感覺便進來。一樁實在不是不誠實的生意交易叫我們感覺到不舒服，

uncomfortable that we re-examine it carefully and decide that, although it is not illegal or dishonest, it is at the same time not 100 per cent honourable. We had perhaps justified our proposed course by careful rationalizations, but our feelings warned us of the need for a decision on a more subtle level. When one path is really known to be right and the other wrong, there is often a real confirmation of our decision by the new peace and joy come when we decide to do the right.

But often we find that the matter is not as simple as that. Our feelings are related not only to our conscience but also to our deepest instincts and to our state of health. We may well have little peace of mind about either of the possible alternatives before us, or, when we are perfectly willing to do whatever God directs, we may still have no assurance in feeling about anything and be left to make decisions and to follow them out in cold blood.

To take an example, no parent should enjoy punishing his children, and he may find it a profoundly upsetting experience on an emotional level. But it is none the less necessary

雖然它不是非法和不正直，卻同時也不是百分百的正直，因此我們再次小心檢視它。也許我們藉小心的推理來證實我們所計劃的方法是合理的，但我們的感覺警告我們有需要作一個更敏銳程度的決定。當真知一條路徑是對而另一條是錯，藉着我們決定來走上正路時，新來的平安和喜樂常能帶來我們在決定上的肯定。

但我們常發覺事情不是那樣簡單。我們的感覺不單與我們的良心有關，也與我們最深入的本能直覺和健康狀況有關。也許我們在前面可能的情況上心中只有些少平安，然而當我們完全樂意作神所引導作的事時，也許仍在任何事上沒有感覺的憑證下來作出和蓄意殘忍地執行決定。

舉一個例，沒有父親會享受懲罰他子女的，他也許會發現在情感上這是一極度不安的經歷。但這不時是必須

and right at times. No minister enjoys exercising discipline in the church but, because he knows it is his duty, he will do it, whatever feelings may suggest. Probably many of us have uncomfortable and almost guilty feelings after any strenuous but necessary Christian controversy, and the person who inwardly rejoices in such debate is a menace. But it is to be feared that much necessary contending for the faith and for righteousness has been prematurely given up because the inward strain was found to be heavy and the disturbed feelings were taken for guidance. Yet in this sinful world we must often force ourselves to do things that are contrary to our natural inclinations and appetites. The man of Christian character is amongst other things, one who is capable of doing extremely distasteful tasks in a straightforward manner.

In the manner of marriage this becomes particularly important. The joy and general sense of well-being that often (but not always) goes with being 'in love' can easily silence conscience and inhibit critical thinking. How often people say that they 'feel led' to get married (and

和正確的。沒有傳道者享受在教會中執行紀律，但因着他知道這是他的職責，因此無論他的感受如何，他是會作這個的。也許我們多人曾在劇烈但必須的基督徒爭論後有着不快和幾乎有着犯罪的感覺，而那辯論的人裏頭的歡欣是危險的。當懼怕的是極多必需為信和公義而有的爭論因着發現內裏的張力太重和不安的情感取代了引導而過早放棄。然而我們在這罪惡的世界必須常強逼我們自己來作與我們天然傾向和喜好相違背的事情。在萬事萬物中有着基督徒品格的人能夠以一明確的態度來作極之討厭的工作。

在婚姻的取態上這尤為重要。開心和幸福的感覺常(但不是總會)同時有着「墮入愛河」的感覺，這能輕易湮沒良知和抑制批判思考。人們何等常說到他們「蒙引導」來結婚(也

probably they will say 'the Lord has so clearly guided') when all they are really describing is a particularly novel state of endocrine balance which makes them feel extremely sanguine and happy. And this comes at a stage when they most need to take counsel from their elders and parents and to sit down and think as calmly as possible. Subsequent broken engagements and even unhappy homes have shown that they had not adequately considered the basic human problems and qualities involved in marriage. Whatever we may think of Victorian lovers it is surprising how successful they were in making stable homes. Yet perhaps it is not surprising: for they refused to get engaged until they had seen each other in their own homes, and the necessity of obtaining parental consent forced them to pay an unwonted attention to wisdom and counsel.

Some readers are likely to feel that this booklet has so far forgotten the work of the Holy Spirit. They do not suggest that inward convictions are a substitute for wisdom and judgment; but according to one tradition of thought, we should not

許他們會說「是主這樣清晰引導的」)，那時他們全都真的在描述一個使他們感到極之滿懷希望和快樂，內分泌平衡的嶄新狀況。他們來到一個最需要得着他們的長輩和父母意見的地步，盡可能安靜坐下思想。最終的解除婚除，甚至不愉快的家庭顯示他們沒有深思熟慮那基本的人類問題和婚姻的應有素質。我們也許會想到維多利亞式的戀人，出奇他們在成立穩定的家庭上是何等成功。然而也許這不足為怪，因為他們是不會訂婚的，除非他們彼此得見對方在本來的家庭中，也必須得到家長的同意，這樣強逼他們在智慧和意見上付上不尋常的留意。

有讀者也許會感到這本小書一直以來忘記了聖靈的工作。他們不認為內裏的信念是作為智慧和判斷的代替品的。但根據傳統的想法，我們不應有所行

act until there is added to the objective criteria mentioned so far an inward assurance and conviction, which, it is affirmed, the Holy Spirit gives. Romans 8:14, 'For all who are led by the Spirit of God are sons of God', is sometimes quoted in this connection. But the context of this verse makes it perfectly clear that what is being demanded is holiness of life and it is stated that no-one should profess to be a son of God who does not show by his holy living that he is being led by God.

The whole problem of guidance, after all, is to know how the Holy Spirit guides—what means He has chosen to use—and the contention of this booklet is that He has never promised to lead us by inward convictions but only by wisdom, judgment and advice based upon knowledge of, and obedience to, the Scriptures.

Let it be acknowledged that God does often give an assurance; but usually it is related not so much to an inward feeling as to a growing realization that the proposed course of action is in accordance with true wisdom. A candidate who offers for missionary service is likely to find, as

動，直至在一直所提及的客觀條件上加上裏頭的確據和承認，就是同意是聖靈所賜的。羅8:14說到的「凡被神的靈引導的，都是神的兒子。」是有時因這情況而被引述的。但這節經文的內容十分清楚地說到所要求的是生命的聖潔，也說到被神引導而未顯明他神聖生活的人是不應稱為神的兒子的。

到頭來，引導的整個問題就是要認識**聖靈如何引導**，祂所選用的是甚麼方法，而這小書的意圖是祂從未應許來藉着裏頭的承認來引導我們，而只是藉着**基於和忠於的聖經知識而來的智慧、判斷和勸告**。

讓我們認定神真的常給與確據，但這常不大關乎內裏的感覺，而是關乎越發明瞭所提出的行動是與真智慧一致的。當一個申請作宣教事奉的人開始為作出準備和受訓，並在他工作

his understanding of the job increases, and as he begins to prepare and train for it, all sorts of small evidences that this is indeed his true vocation. If he inspects his feelings they may well be pursuing a course of violent oscillation between fear of launching out, and perhaps being a failure, and confident assurance in God's power. If he is leaving aged parents, or other loved ones, his feeling ought to be upset by the prospect. But as things proceed he is increasingly assured in his mind that this course of action is the right one.

‘And though the Lord give you the bread of adversity and the water of affliction, yet your Teacher will not hide himself anymore, but your eyes shall see your Teacher. And your ears shall hear a word behind you, saying, “This is the way, walk in it,” when you turn to the right or when you turn to the left.’ (Isaiah 30:20-21) It is clear that the ‘word’ which they will hear is the word of ‘your Teacher’, but he will be visibly present. That is to say it is a promise that the day will come when the people of God will not be left without a reliable teacher whom they will see and hear amongst them. He will faithfully warn them when they

的認識上有所增加，有着各種類型的微小證據時，很可能發現這就真是他正確的使命。他若搜查他的感覺，便會發現他是在因着可能失敗而害怕成行和對神能力的確實信靠之間盪來盪去。他若要離開年老雙親或戀人時，他的感覺該因着前路而困擾。但當一切進行中時，在他心中便越來越確實這行動是對的。

「主雖然以艱難給你當餅，以困苦給你當水，*你的教師*卻不再隱藏，你眼必看見*你的教師*。你或向左，或向右，你必聽見後邊有聲音說：這是正路，要行在其間。」（賽30:20-21）明顯地他們必聽見的是你「教師」的說話，但祂是看不見的。即是說這是一個應許，那日要來到，神的子民必不會落得沒可靠的教師，必在他們當中得見和得聽祂。當他們犯罪時，祂必會專誠來警告他們，

sin and cause them to repent and so deliver them from God's judgments (see verses 22-26). There is nothing here about an inward hunch. This presumably refers to the fuller revelation of the New Testament given to us in Scripture, or, to the first Christians, in the words of Christ and His apostles. There is nothing here to suggest that the Holy Spirit will speak to us in inward hunches and intuition. As Peter puts it, in 2 Peter 1:18-21, 'we have the prophetic word made more sure' even than the 'voice borne from heaven' which they heard with their physical ears on the mount of transfiguration.

This passage from Isaiah has often been used to suggest that we cannot be guided when stationary and that we must make decisions and go ahead and expect to be checked as and when we go wrong. This is no doubt wise advice and it is perfectly true that to dither over a decision for too long leads to psychological strain and, after a time, the inability to make decisions about anything. If what has been said in this booklet about judgment and wisdom is true, then it is our duty to decide and go ahead until it is made clear that we must

使他們悔改，叫他們免於神的審判（參看賽30:22-26）。這不是甚麼，而是一個內裏的預感。這大抵是指着在聖經中給我們新約那更全面的啟示，又或是基督和祂的門徒給與初期基督徒的說話。在這裏從沒有說到聖靈必會用內裏的預感和直覺向我們說話。正如彼得在彼後1:18-21所說的：「我們並有先知更確的預言。」比起在變像山上他們肉身耳朵所聽到「從天上來的聲音」更確實。

這取自以賽亞書的經文常被用來說到當我們靜止時是得不着引導的，我們必須作出決定，往前行，且期待在出錯時被尋查出來。無疑這是一智慧的意見，在決定上長久猶豫不決會帶來心理上的緊張是完全對的，並且時間一久，在任何事上都沒有能力來作出決定。在這本小書中所曾說到關於判斷和智慧的都是真確的，那麼這是我們的責

change our course. But the correction is likely to come from unexpected circumstances (2 Corinthians 1), obviously wrong consequences which we had not foreseen, the advice of friends or a new appreciation of a scriptural truth previously overlooked. A missionary candidate may be prevented at the last moment from going abroad, for instance, by her mother's sudden illness or by someone bringing home to her that she is disobeying the instruction to care for her own household. It is better to make the decision and plan to go, if that seems right, and then realize that it just would not be possible, than to hover on the brink of decision too long. Sometimes the real consequences of a decision are hard to assess until you have started to carry it out. Many Christians have to take important decisions with their feelings in a hopeless turmoil. Often they find no assurance for a long time; but, after they have followed the chosen path for some months or years, it becomes increasingly clear that the Lord did, as He promised, give wisdom. A woman may, for instance, refuse an offer of marriage from a Christian man for good

任來決定和前行，直至清楚知道我們定須改變路程。但是改正是極可能在想不到的情況下來到（林後1章），明顯的錯誤後果是我們看不見的，朋友的勸告和對新近屬靈真理的嶄新領受我們也會忽略。例如一個宣教申請者也許在最後一刻因她母親的急病，或因某人上門說到她不服從指示來照管她一己的家務而被阻止。在似乎是正確時便作出決定和計劃前行，但之後發現這是沒有可能，總好過長時間在決定的邊沿上徘徊。有時一個決定的真正後果是難以評價的，除非你已開始實行。很多基督徒在他們的感覺落在無助的混亂中時作那重大的決定。他們常是久久找不着確據，但在他們遵照所選路徑走上數月或數年後，便越發清晰主真的照所應許的賜下智慧。例如，一個婦人也許因着某些美好的原因來拒絕一個基督徒男子

reasons, but be left with deeply disturbed feelings about her decision for years. Often it is only very much later that it is confirmed beyond any possible doubt that that was the right course. Time may bring overwhelming assurance through good reasons which were not at first appreciated. The same is probably true of most vocations; it is only after a while that it becomes absolutely clear what is right and a change of plans does not necessarily mean that we made a mistake in the first place (cf. Paul). It may be that we were intended to start that way and change later on. Like David, we may find that: 'Whereas it was in your heart to build a house for my name, you did well that it was in your heart; nevertheless you shall not build the house' (2 Chronicles 6:8-9).

When all has been said, however, it clearly is the experience of many Christians that they have at times had very strong feelings that they ought to go and do something or see someone, when they can think of no logical reason for doing so. The biographies of some Christians relate instances of this sort, where clearly the inward urge was God's way of

的求婚，卻經年因她的決定而落在深深的困擾情感中。常是過後多時才排除任何可能的疑慮來確實這方向是正確的。時間藉着美好原因帶來勢不可擋的確據，是開初不領會的。在大部份的使命上可能同樣都是那樣真實。只要過一會兒便變得十分清楚甚麼是對的，而改變計劃是不必要地解作我們在開初便犯錯（看看保羅）。有可能我們一心想這樣開始的，但之後改變了方向。像大衛一樣，我們可能發現「你立意要為我的名建殿，這意思甚好。只是你不可建殿。」（代下6:8-9）

話雖如此，很多基督徒明顯經歷他們時不時有該去做某事或見某人的十分強烈感覺，卻想不到要這樣作的合理原因。一些基督徒的傳記記着這類型的事例，明顯地裏頭的催促是神引導的方法。這樣的引導須被較客觀的準則所

guiding. Such guidance must be checked by more objective standards and it would seem to be our duty to pray that God will rather give us reasons for such actions. Certainly there is no indication in the Bible that it is 'spiritually minded' to be controlled by such feelings and urges, as a matter of general practice. We must, however, agree that God may lead us in this way where the decision is strictly neutral from a moral point of view and no objective guidance is available. Owing to our ignorance and sinful lack of sensitiveness to the needs of other there may be no other way of showing us the path.

9 Circumstances

We know that in everything God works for good with those who love him, who are called according to his purpose. (Romans 8:28)

It is often stated that guidance can come by way of circumstances, and this is, of course, perfectly true, because God creates and controls circumstances. But such guidance is by no means easy to determine. The devil is apparently allowed, not only to arrange signs, but also to bring about remarkable coincidences to

檢視，並且祈禱神為那行動來給我們原因似乎是我們的責任。在聖經肯定沒有這樣的指示，說到在普遍的實行上，「屬靈的心思」當被這樣的感覺和催促所管理。但我們定必要同意神會以這方法來引導我們，從道德的觀點來看，在沒有提供客觀的引導下，那個決定是全然中性的。因着我們的無知和對別人的需要上敏感不足顯為有罪下，再沒可能有別的方法來將路徑給我們顯明了。

九 環境

「我們曉得萬事都互相效力，叫愛神的人得益處，就是按祂旨意被召的人。」（羅8:28）

常有人說引導可以以環境的方式而來。這當然是完全正確的，因為創造和掌管環境的是神。但這樣的引導是絲毫不容易確定的。魔鬼似乎不單止被容許安排異兆，也可帶來顯著的巧合來試探我們犯罪。

tempt us to evil. We have already mentioned the remarkable circumstantial 'guidance' to do wrong which David received. We do not know if he argued from circumstantial guidance when he happened to see Bathsheba bathing; but many people have justified obviously wrong marriages, or even divorces, because of some exceptional coincidence attendant on their meeting.

Yet circumstances are clearly not irrelevant, as a few biblical examples may show. In the first place, negatively, circumstances may absolutely forbid some course of action. Paul in his missionary journeys seems to have moved on to a new place whenever persecution reached such a pitch that public ministry was no longer possible. Equally, he always preached first in the synagogues; but when they rejected the message, he changed his method and went to the Gentiles. There was also positive guidance from circumstances. Paul's appeal to Caesar (Acts 25:11) seems to have been finally determined by circumstances, because it was the only escape from murder on the way up to Jerusalem or, perhaps, an indefinitely prolonged imprisonment.

我們曾提及大衛所得顯著環境上的「引導」來犯錯。我們不知道當他看見拔示巴沐浴時究竟有否以這是否環境上的引導作辯解，但多人曾明顯地為錯誤的婚姻甚或離婚來證明有理，是因着他們所出席聚會上的一些異常巧合。

然而環境明顯不是不相關的，正如一些聖經例子所顯示的。首先，環境相反地是禁止一些行徑的。保羅在他的宣教行程中，每當逼迫臨到一個極點，公開的傳道不再可能時，似乎是要往一新地方去了。同樣地，他總是先在會堂傳講的，但當他們拒絕信息時，他便改變他的方法，往外邦人去。也有正面的環境引導的。保羅向該撒的申訴（徒25:11）似乎最終是環境使然的，因為這是唯一逃離在耶路撒冷之暗殺的方法，又或者這是一無盡的延長關押。明顯他是期望這會

He clearly hoped that this would lead to his being set free. Paul also knew how to seize sudden and unexpected opportunities as at Athens, where he immediately took his chance of speaking on 'Mars Hill'.

At the same time Paul and the other New Testament Christians were not put off by adverse circumstances from an energetic and confident evangelistic ministry. For example, when the rulers began to persecute them, in Acts 4, they did not pray for the persecution to be removed but only that they might have grace nevertheless to go on witnessing boldly and with signs following (Acts 4:29-30). Circumstances seem to have been accepted as guidance only when they rendered an apparently desirable course of action really impossible, or morally wrong, or else opened unexpected opportunities for doing good. This was presumably because of their confidence in His control of all things in the world.

Probably every Christian has had examples of this kind of thing in his own life. Ill-health has prevented him from attending an interview for a job. Missing a train by mistake has brought him into profitable

叫他得着釋放的。保羅也知道如何在雅典抓着突如其來和意想不到的機會，他立時抓着在亞略巴古那兒講論的良機。

同時，保羅和其他新約基督徒沒有因着逆境來推諉不作那積極和充滿自信的福音傳講。例如，在徒4章當管治者開始迫害他們時，他們沒有祈求除去迫害，他們不過只祈求得以有着恩典並神蹟奇事來勇敢作見證（徒4:29-30）。環境被接納為引導，似乎只有當環境所致使的是一個似乎稱心的行徑，而這行徑是真的沒有可能，或是道德上是錯誤的，又或者開啟了一個始料不及行善的機會。這大抵是因為他們在神掌管世上萬事萬物上有着確信。

在每個基督徒的人生中也許有着這樣的事例。患病阻止了他出席一個職位的面試。意外地錯過一班火車帶給他與一個乘客有着有益的

conversation with a fellow passenger. In the story of our own conversion there were probably incidents, not all planned by us, but important in bringing us under the sound of the gospel or making us open-minded towards the gospel. We accept these things as part of God's providential control of 'all things according to the counsel of his will', and we are grateful for the confidence that this gives that, so long as we follow what we believe to be right, He can and will overrule our circumstances to keep us from evil and from doing anything damaging to His purposes. We must have this confidence as Christians or we would be driven to distraction by anxiety about our decisions.

This is a further context in which prayer is important. Often we are moved to pray that God will remove some apparently insuperable barrier, and if He does we have the greatest confidence that the plan is a right one. Some missionary societies, for instance, habitually delay new and apparently desirable developments until at least a part of the necessary money is available as special gifts for the purposes. In this way they test the guidance which they believe they

對話。在我們一己的談話的事例中，可能意外地，全然並非我們所計劃下，特特領我們說出福音，或使我們虛心看待福音。我們接受這些事情為神旨意管理下叫「萬事按祂旨意」而行的一部分。我們也為那確信存感謝的心，只要按我們相信是對的而行，祂必能和必會掌管我們的環境來保守我們不犯罪，不作任何破壞祂計劃的事。我們必須有這確信，我們作為基督徒要有這確信，否則我們會因着在決定上疑慮而不得不心懷二意。

文首經文進一步說到祈禱的重要性。我們常被鼓動來祈求神除去一些似乎是不可克服的障礙，祂若這樣作時，我們便有着最大的確信那計劃是對的。例如一些宣教團體習慣地延遲一些嶄新和明顯是理想的發展，直至最少有部分所需金錢以這事奉的特別獻金方式臨到為止。他們以這方法檢視

have been given through wisdom. There are obviously limits to this, because we have no promise that God will give us a 'sign'; but where it is a matter of circumstances making possible what at first seemed impossible, though right, we are not asking a sign in Gideon's sense but only asking God to open the way for us to obey Him along this particular path. A young woman missionary candidate, for example, may be prevented from sailing by the stubborn opposition of parents or a mother's ill-health, and she may well pray for these obstacles to be removed.

On the other hand if such prayer is not answered we must accept the guidance that God gives by making circumstances impossible. Often He has a better plan. At the time of the rise of Communism in China many people prayed, and prayed believingly, that freedom for missionary work would not be lost. This prayer was not answered and the triumph of Communism seemed to be a disaster. Now, however, some years afterwards, we can see a little part of the reason. Hundreds of missionaries have been released for work in other,

引導，相信這引導藉智慧而來。這明顯有着限制，因神沒有應許必給我們一個「表記物」，但環境一事是可使開初似乎沒可能的成為可能。雖然是對，但我們不會求神像基甸般給我們一個表記物，卻只會求神為我們開啟前路，叫我們循這特別路徑走來遵從祂。舉一個例，一個申請宣教的年輕女士可能因固執父母的反對或母親的患病而未能成行，她也許為除去這些障礙而多多禱告。

另一方面，這樣的禱告若不蒙垂聽，我們定會接受說神使環境的不可能來作出引導，祂常有一更佳的計劃。多人因共產主義在中國興起而禱告，有信心地禱告，叫宣教工作不致失去。這禱告未蒙垂聽，而共產黨的得勝似乎是一個災難。但是，多年過後的如今，我們得見部分的原因。千百的宣教士已被發往別處來工作，有些是到了一些更

and in some cases even less evangelized areas, and it seems that this was part of the reason why history was allowed to take this course. Paul spent most, if not all, of his stay in Rome as a prisoner. This was clearly not the way in which he expected to arrive, or to minister there; but it is doubtful whether he could have lived and ministered for so long unmolested by the Jews if he had been a free man.

10 Conditions of guidance

He leads the humble in what is right ... those who keep his covenant and his testimonies ... the man that fears the Lord. (Psalm 25:9, 10, 12)

In the first place, it is only those who are personal Christians who are promised any guidance at all. It is 'with those who love him' that 'in everything God works for good'. Guidance may at times be given to others, in order to lead them to repentance and faith, but no-one who is not a true Christian has a right to turn to God in prayer and claim His help and favour in perplexity.

Secondly, we must say that sincere obedience to God is a

未福音化的地區，似乎這是部分的原因為何歷史上容許這樣的進程。保羅作為一個囚犯在羅馬停留，若不是全部便是大部分的時間。明顯這不是他期望到達那裏和在那裏傳道的方法。他若是一個自由的人，能否那麼長久不被猶太人干擾下來活着和傳道，這是存疑的。

十 引導的條件

「祂必按公平引領謙卑人.....凡遵守祂的約和祂法度的人.....誰敬畏耶和華。」（詩 25:9,10, 12）

一、蒙應許得引導的惟有是個別的基督徒。「愛神的人」才得神的「萬事互相效力」。也許有時引導會給與別人，為的是領他們來進入悔改和信心，但從沒有不是真實基督徒的人有權在困苦中來禱告，向神索求祂的幫助和益處。

二、我們定須說到對神忠誠上的順服是得

condition of guidance.

If I had cherished iniquity in my heart, the Lord would not have listened. (Psalm 66:18)

If there is deliberate disobedience in our lives, or in our attitudes, we cannot expect His fatherly and gracious leading, but only His correction and chastising. One hears of Christians who are absorbed in some difficult and apparently insoluble problem of guidance, whose real problem turns out to be a matter of known sin in the life. The question of guidance seems to have been merely a distraction to enable the mind to forget the real issue.

Psalm 25, however, and many similar passages lay their stress, not so much on deliberate sin, as on a wrong attitude. They insist on the need for an attitude of meekness, teachableness and humility. 'God', we are warned, 'opposes the proud, but gives grace to the humble' (1 Peter 5:5). It is a mockery to ask for wisdom if we are not willing and eager to obey God's will once it is discerned. Some people ask for guidance with regard to a career but refuse to go to missionary meetings in case they should receive a call to the mission

引導的條件。

「我若心裏注重罪孽，主必不聽。」（詩 66:18）

若在我們生命或我們的態度上有故意的不順服，便不能期望得祂愛護和恩典的引領，卻只有祂的更正和懲罰了。有人聽到一經受困難和在引導的問題上明顯得不着解釋的人，他真正的問題到頭來是在生命上有已知的罪惡。引導的問題似乎只是分散注意力，叫心思忘記真的問題所在吧了。

但詩25篇和眾多類似經文所強調的不大在於故意的罪，而在於錯誤的態度。他們堅持說到溫順態度、受教和謙卑的需要。警告我們的是「神阻擋驕傲的人，賜恩給謙卑的人。」（彼前5:5）若我們祈求智慧卻不願意和樂於遵行所辨識的神旨意時，這徒勞無功。有人在使命上尋求引導，卻拒絕出席宣教聚會，免得接獲到宣教工場去的呼召。在

field. In Psalm 32, after promising to guide us, God adds:

Be not like a horse or a mule, without understanding, which must be curbed with bit and bridle, else it will not keep with you.

That is to say, if we want guidance we must be willing to obey intelligently. It should be the desire of every Christian at all costs to obey God and to please Him, and, as soon as we depart from this attitude, we are likely to be in difficulties.

Probably every Christian has at times had difficulty here. Particularly in decisions that concern something we very much want to do it is hard to be sure that we are not merely indulging in wishful thinking, or asking God to confirm a course of action that we have already determined. If we are honest we shall never be certain that our motives are absolutely pure. We know our own hearts too well. In such a decision we must pray for a true objectivity and ask God to give us such an overriding desire for His honour and glory that we are able to judge aright. But it is no good indulging in endless introspection. We must make allowance for our own selfishness and get on. By all means

詩32篇中，神在應許引導我們後，接着說：

「你不可像那無知的騾馬，必用嚼環轡頭勒住牠，不然，就不能馴服。」（詩32:9）

這是說，我們若想得引導，定須明智地順服。不惜一切來順服神和討神喜悅該是每個基督徒的渴望。我們一旦偏離這態度，我們便很可能落在困難中了。

也許每個基督徒有時在此遇上困難。尤其是在關乎一些我們極想作之事上的決定，很難去肯定我們不是只沉溺在渴想中，或是祈求神來在我們早已有決定的行徑上開綠燈。我們若誠實，便永不會肯定我們的動機是絕對純潔的。我們十分清楚我們一己之心。在這樣的決定上我們定須以真實的客觀來禱告，祈求神在祂的尊貴和榮耀上給我們超越一切的愛慕，因而有正確的判斷。沉溺在無盡的反省沒有好處，這只會默許我們一

we must pray about it and ask to be given a willingness which does not come naturally to us and a fresh love for Him which makes selfish consideration small. But then we must turn to the objective task of seeking out the divine wisdom of the matter, determined that, by God's grace, we will obey whatever is right. And what is right is not always the most unpleasant or the most reckless alternative.

It is here that the day-by-day devotional life of the Christian comes in. If we are not 'abiding in Christ' our standard of values can quickly become debased, and if we are not making full use of the means of grace at our disposal our devotional life is not likely to remain sincere and fresh for long. We may, of course, retain all the pious shibboleths, but they can easily become a mere habit of speech. We must see to it that our affections as well as our intellect are set on pleasing God. Or, to put it in terms of Psalm 25, 'For thee I wait all the day long ... The friendship of the Lord is for those who fear him ... My eyes are ever towards the Lord; for he will pluck my feet out of the net.' Or as James puts it on the negative side,

己的自私，一直這樣。我們務必為這禱告，祈求賜與不會自然臨到我們的樂意，和減少自私考慮那對祂純新的愛。之後我們定須轉向尋求神聖智慧本身這實在的目標，決意藉神的恩典必能順服任何正確的東西。而正確的東西不總叫人歡快，或是相反地最不受注意。

基督徒日復一日的獻身生命就這樣進來。若非住在基督裏，我們的價值觀很快便變質。若在定意上不完全使用恩典的方法，我們的敬虔生命就不能長久保持真誠和清新了。當然我們仍能有敬虔的用語，卻流為口頭禪吧了。我們定須以我們的情感和智力來討神喜悅。或者以詩25篇的用語來說：「我終日等候祢。.....耶和華與敬畏祂的人親密。.....我的眼目時常仰望耶和華，因為祂必將我的腳從網裏拉出來。」（詩25:5, 14-15）或如雅各般反面來看：「你們

‘You ask and do not receive, because you ask wrongly, to spend it on your passions.’

Thirdly, we may say that prayer is a condition of guidance. ‘If any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask God.’ It is easier than it sounds to neglect this and to become so preoccupied with thinking out the problem that we forget to pray. At the same time we must remember that we are not heard for our much speaking. To spend an hour worrying on our knees is not prayer. Indeed, there are often times when it is our duty, having committed a problem to God in prayer, to stop praying and to trust and to do the necessary work to arrive at a solution. If a problem becomes really worrying this is probably always the case. It may then be helpful to talk to someone and perhaps pray with them about it; but few, if any, of us are able in solitary prayer to do more than worry on our knees after a short time. The longer we spend and the more tired we become, the more impossible it is to give ourselves to intercession on the matter. We simply let our difficulty go round and round in our minds.

The place of prayer is more

求也得不着，是因為你們妄求，要浪費在你們的宴樂中。」（雅4:3）

三、我們也可說禱告是蒙引導的條件。「你們中間若有缺少智慧的，應當求……神。」（雅1:5）禱告比起說被困難纏擾而忽略這應許來忘記禱告還容易。同時我們定須謹記我們不會因多說而蒙垂聽。屈膝一小時卻擔擔憂憂便不是禱告了。常有我們負責任的時間，就是真的在禱告中將問題交託神後，便停止禱告，信靠祂，作所需要的工作來叫解決方法臨到為止。若問題變得真的可擔憂時，總會這樣。那麼與某人談談，或與他們為此禱告也許有幫助。但我們少有人能夠獨自禱告，最多跪下來擔憂一會兒吧了。所花時間越長，我們變得越疲倦，便越難叫我們自己在這事情上祈求。我們不過叫我們的困難在我們思想上轉來轉去吧了。

祈禱室該常是我們

usually that we should mention our need before God repeatedly. Let it be something placed daily in His wise, loving and holy hands and left there with confidence. Many Christians, a long time before marriage can be reasonably contemplated, prayer about the matter; and it is good also, as soon as our decisions begin seriously to affect our future, to pray that we may be led aright in the matter of our vocation. Then, when these become pressing problems requiring decision, we can the more easily trust God and pray believingly for His wisdom.

These conditions are simple but basic. They concern our daily walk with Christ and are matters which are in any case our Christian duty and privilege quite apart from any particular needs. It should not require a crisis in our life to persuade us of their necessity, or to show us that they have been neglected.

11 Vocation

Doing the will of God from the heart. (Ephesians 6:6)

When the Bible deals with the matter of doing God's will it is less concerned with the problems of

在神面前重覆提到我們需要的地方。總要每天把東西放在祂智慧、慈祥和神聖的手中，信靠地留在那兒。很多基督徒久在結婚前長時為這禱告，這是好的，因我們的決定開始嚴重地影響我們的未來，因此以禱告來叫我們在我們使命的事上被正確引導也是好的。那麼當這些成為需要決定的迫切問題時，我們能更容易來信靠神和有信心地祈求祂的智慧。

這些情況雖簡單卻基本。他們關乎我們與基督每天同行，關乎在任何情況下基督徒的責任和殊榮與遠非任何特別需要的事情。我們不需要生死攸關來證明他們的必需，或向我們顯明他們的一直被忽略。

十一 使命

「從心裏遵行神的旨意。」(弗6:6)

聖經論到行神旨意時，在尋求神旨意上的困難比起行神旨意上的

discovering it than with the difficulty of doing it. This booklet is about discovering it but many of the problems of guidance arise from a failure to think about 'ordinary' work in the way that the Bible does, so as to see that the Christian's vocation could as readily be to scrub floors as to preach. Not everyone is meant to preach and to most of us an 'ordinary' job is not a second best.

In this passage in Ephesians 6 Paul is urging both slaves and masters to do their work in such a way that they see it as doing the will of God. Only so can it be done 'from the heart', wholeheartedly, especially when, as slaves, it was often exceedingly unpleasant. It must surely be possible to see our job, or our other roles in society, in this same way today. Indeed we must do so. We must work towards an attitude that makes our tasks a vocation from God.

The difficulty arises from a failure to take in two truths that are implied in this passage. First, there is the fact that in carrying out our tasks we are pleasing and serving God. That, he says, is true even of tasks we didn't choose to do ourselves. As it says in the next verse (Eph. 6:7) 'rendering

困難更少被關注。這小書是要尋求神的旨意，但眾多引導上困難的出現，是因不能以聖經的方法來想到「尋常」的工作，並不能欣然地視洗擦地板如同傳道般為基督徒的使命。不是每一個人都要傳道，我們只有「尋常」工作的大部分人並不是次好的。

保羅在弗6章勸告奴僕和主人都作工，都視之為行神旨意來作。只有這樣才是「從心裏」，全心全意地來作，尤其那些常是格外不快為奴的。今天是確實可以這相同的方法來看我們的職業，或社會上的其他崗位。我們真的必可這樣。我們必須以我們的工作是來自神給的使命這態度來進發。

困難因不能接受文首經文所包含的兩個真理而出現。一、事實上我們作工是要討神喜悅和事奉神。他說到我們作不是自己選擇之工也是正確的。正如下一節「甘心事奉，好像服事

service with a good will as to the Lord and not to men'. That is to say we do this job for Him because He wants it done. So we do it with a good will. How can we do less if He cares about it and it matters to Him how the task is carried out? But that is not all. Slaves' work is rightly translated here as 'service'. Jesus reminded us that our heavenly Father loves to 'make his sun rise on the evil and on the good, and sends rain on the just and on the unjust' (Mt. 5:45) and goes on to tell us to be like Him in that attitude. Therefore any task that can be said to be helpful to anyone else (even to a cruel slave master) is doubly satisfactory. But most jobs fall into that category. They may only do so indirectly by increasing employment or wealth, improving education or health, or advancing people's knowledge and understanding of God's world and of human nature.

The Christian, therefore, should be capable of enthusiasm for most jobs on both counts, and this is not the only New Testament passage where this positive enthusiasm for plain manual or other 'secular' work is required of the Christian. He is

主，不像服事人。」(弗 6:7) 所說的。這說到我們因祂想這樣作成來為神作工，因此我們以良好意願來作。若祂顧念這個，祂且重視工作如何進行時，我們怎能少作？不止這樣。這裏「奴僕的工作」該正意翻譯為「服事」。耶穌提醒我們說我們的天父喜愛「叫日頭照好人，也照歹人，降雨給義人，也給不義的人。」(太5:45) 且繼續告訴他們要在這態度上像祂。因此任何據稱對任何人有幫助的工作（甚至作殘暴主人的奴僕）是雙倍滿足的。大部分工作所屬類型只在間接增加受聘用或財富，改善教育或健康，或增進人們對神的世界和人類本性的知識和理解。

因此基督徒該在大部分的職位上並同時在兩造之間熱心，這不是唯一的新約經文說到有着在普通操作或其他「世俗」的工作上需要基督徒有正面的熱心。

expected to have a real sense of vocation in his work. Even if it is not the job we would have chosen and has no directly 'spiritual' components it is our task to give it that spiritual dimension.

This traditional biblical doctrine of vocation has been sadly neglected recently. Indeed in some circles 'a vocation' means a call to the full-time ministry of the church. But that is far from the New Testament idea. If slaves' work could take on this character how much more easily should work in industry, business, teaching and a hundred and one other jobs that do not give in themselves an opportunity of direct ministry of the Word? In some we have to think hard about their positive value to society but, with few exceptions, they are a part of God's task for man in His world and, therefore worthy vocations.

In others (e.g. medicine and social work) we easily lose the divine perspective because the service aspect is so clear. But we must think our way through to a position where we rejoice in a role as a vocation in which we can serve God and men. The Bible shows that a truly Christian

所期待於他的是有着所作使命的真正認識。即使這工作不是我們所選擇，且沒有直接「屬靈」成分，這工作我們仍可給與其屬靈的量度。

使命的傳統聖經原則一直都可悲地被忽略。在某些圈子中「使命」真的只指着教會的全時間事奉吧了。但這與新約聖經的意念大相逕庭。若奴僕的工作能取上這特徵，那麼在不能傳講神話語和直接事奉的工業、商業、教學和千百種其他職位上豈不更容易作？我們難以想到某些工種對社會有着正面的價值，但是除了少部分之外，他們是神給人在祂世界上的部分工作，因此是有價值的使命。

其他如醫藥和社會工作的行業，因服事方面的那樣清晰，我們輕易失卻那神聖看法。我們必須正向來思想，作為使命上的一員來服事神和人而歡欣。聖經顯示真實的基督徒心思必

mind will see the most menial jobs in this light. Much frustration and disappointment with our present job is saved if we learn to see it like this, even while, at the same time, we may be looking for something better suited to our training and ability.

12 Ambitions

Whoever would save his life will lose it, and whoever loses his life for my sake will find it. (Matthew 16:25)

Seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things shall be yours as well. (Matthew 6:33)

There is, according to these sayings, a certain perversity built into life. The man who energetically seeks his own good, will fail to find it, while the man who has his aims set on God's purposes rather than his own, will find that his needs are met. Indeed, man 'finds himself' by looking outside himself. Real life is given where life is surrendered.

The first question we need to ask ourselves therefore is not how a decision may affect me and my little world (God is looking after that) but rather we need to ask what God's

會以這亮光來看最卑下的工種。我們若學會這樣來看，就可免卻很多對我們現今職位的挫敗感和失望，同時也可渴望一些更適合作為我們訓練和能力的東西了。

十二 抱負

「因為凡要救自己生命的，必喪掉生命。凡為我喪掉生命的，必得着生命。」(太16:25)

「你們要先求祂的國和祂的義。這些東西都要加給你們了。」(太6:33)

根據這些經文，生命中內置相當剛愎。積極地尋求一己利益的人不能找到，而那立志以神而不是他一己心意為己任的人會發現他所需的必然得着滿足。人真的藉往己外望來找到自己！**真實的生命給與那些降服生命的人。**

因此我們要自省的首個問題便不是一個決定如何影響我和（神正照管）我的細小世界，我們反需問甚麼才是神

purposes are and how they are best fulfilled. These may be purposes which have little immediately to do with my desires. Nevertheless God promises that those who are so orientated will find what they need. We can be, and should be, enthusiastically caught up in the great privilege of serving God, even while we gladly shed some superficial ambitions in that pursuit.

A high proportion of the population, for instance, complain about lack of job satisfaction. The main reason for that seems to be simply that they are trying to find job satisfaction. The more they chase that ideal the more elusive it becomes. Meanwhile one of the marks of a Christian is that he has an enthusiasm for his job. That is not because it provides a satisfying end in itself but precisely because he sees and aims beyond it. In that wider aim he finds satisfaction in his job (Col. 3:22-24).

Many non-Christians say that they find marriage and the home restricting and stuffy. But what can they expect if they thought that marriage in itself would be totally satisfying? This marvelous gift of God is a very inadequate God-substitute. If

的旨意，和如何得以作成。這些旨意可能與我們所渴望的沒有緊密關係。神卻依然應許說，那些定志的人必會找到他們所需要的。我們能和應該在服事神的偉大殊榮上被熱烈地逮住，那怕我們正欣然地在這追求上流露一些膚淺的抱負。

例如多人在缺乏工作滿足感上埋怨，主要原因似乎不過是他們正盡力尋找工作的滿足感。他們越發追求這理想，便越發得不到。現今基督徒的一個標誌就是在工作上具備熱心。這非因它本身提供令人滿意的結局，而是因他所見和所指望的超乎這個。他是在這更廣闊的指望下來找到工作上的滿足感（西3:22-24）。

很多非基督徒認為婚姻和家庭受限制和沉悶。當他們認為婚姻本身完全可滿足時，還有甚麼期望？這奇妙的恩賜十分不適切來代替神。我們若嘗試以此為

we try to make it our idol we find it most disappointing. And yet, working together for the glory of God, it is one of the greatest gifts given to men. A marriage directed like that is enriched out of all recognition and provides much of what people look for when they try to make it an end in itself.

This is not to suggest that the job, the home, the career, are simply means to an end (see chapter 11). The Christian must be concerned to glorify God in the way that he lives and acts in every area of his life. As a result he enjoys them more than the man or woman to whom success is everything.

At the same time the Bible does encourage a certain kind of ambition. Indeed it demands it of us. Paul, in Philippians 1, puts it like this, 'To me to live is Christ, and to die is gain ... I am hard pressed between the two. My desire is to depart and be with Christ, for that is far better. But to remain in the flesh is more necessary on your account. Convinced of this, I know that I shall remain and continue with you all ...'

This gives us a remarkable glimpse of his inner priorities. Of course, he would love to be with

我們的偶像時，便發現其最令人失望。若為神的榮耀來一起經營，便成為神給人其中一個最偉大恩賜。像這樣蒙指示的婚姻滿得所有人的認可，並多多給與人所尋找的。

這不是說職位、家庭、前途不過是達至目標的手段（參看本書十一章）。基督徒定須在他生活和生命每個領域的行止上榮耀神。因此他比起凡事上成功的男男女女所得享的還要多。

聖經同時真的鼓勵某類型的抱負，聖經真的是這樣要求我們的。保羅在腓1章是這樣說的：「我活着就是基督，我死了就有益處。.....我正在兩難之間，情願離世與基督同在，因為這是好得無比的。然而我在肉身活着，為你們更是要緊的。」（腓1:21, 23-24）

這叫我們非凡一瞥保羅的心之所重。當然，他愛與基督一起，

Christ, finally freed from sin, enjoying sharing in the unhindered worship of heaven. But even that is not his priority. It is more important to him to be useful to the church and to the spread of the gospel. His concern is to complete the job given to him and to serve men while he can. He puts that before his own spiritual blessedness.

So we are to be ambitious! We are to seek God's kingdom with all our energies. That does not only mean to seek the spread of the gospel. It means a concern for all that furthers His will for men. We are also to be concerned to be useful to men while we can. Even though Paul is speaking in the context of Christian ministry, the same rule applies in due proportion to other roles in life. There is necessary Christian ambition to develop our gifts and then to use them to the very best—to be as useful as possible.

Let us suppose that there are three teaching posts advertised in the press for all of which we are professionally qualified; the headship, the head of the mathematics department and the school counsellor. If we want one of these jobs we should first try to judge our

至終從罪中得釋放，有分於天上不受限制的敬拜。但這不是他心之所重，對他來說為教會所用和福音得傳講更為重要。他的關注是盡他所能來完成交付他的工作和服事人。他以此高於他一己屬靈恩福之上。

因此我們要有抱負！盡力尋求神的國。這不單說到尋求福音的傳講，且說到對所有叫他更能為人促進祂旨意上的關注。我們也要盡可能於人有幫助。雖然保羅說到的是基督徒的職事，但相同的原則也適用於生命中的其他角色。必需有基督徒的抱負來發展我們的恩賜，之後盡用他們，盡量的成為別人的幫助。

讓我們假切在報章中有三則教席的廣告：校長、數學系主任和學校社工，其專業資格我們全都符合。我們若想得到其中一個職位，便該先盡力評定我們的恩賜，之後我們便能嘗試

gifts, then we can try to decide what fits in with our own long-term ambitions of Christian usefulness. The headship has the prestige and the money (and the long hours); the mathematics job demands real skill as a teacher and love of the subject; the counsellor's job requires primarily pastoral gifts. It is doubtful whether we should apply for any of these jobs unless we have reason to think that we can do them well, or can grow into doing them well. For instance the good classroom teacher is not always a good headmaster or a good counsellor. On the other hand our accumulated experience may well equip us to take the more prestigious headship and to stretch our capacity to give to the community in that way. Our influence in the community will be greater though less personal if we are the head. If, however, our real gift is pastoral, at least at this stage of our life, we will be frustrated as headmaster and probably do it badly. But if we can separate our personal ambition for the boosting of our ego from our duty to do our utmost to serve God and men, then we should be ambitious.

Baruch was told by Jeremiah, 'Do

決定甚麼切合我們一己基督徒合用性上的長期追求目標。校長有其威望和薪金（並那長工時）；而數學工作要求老師的真才實學和對科目的熱愛；而社工的工作首要地需求牧者的愛。我們在該申請哪個職位上有困惑，除非我們有理由以為我們能作好他們，或能漸漸作好他們。一個好教師不常是一位好校長或好社工。另一方面，我們累積的經驗也許裝備好我們來取上那更受尊敬的領導地位，來一展所長來在這方面供獻社會。作校長對社會的影響較大，但對個人的影響則較少。但最少在我們這生命階段中我們的真正恩賜若是牧養的話，我們必會在作校長上挫敗，也許作得很差。我們若能將吹噓我們自我的個人抱負跟我們盡力來服事神和服事人的責任分開的話，那麼我們便可算為有抱負的了。

耶利米對巴錄說

you seek great things for yourself? Seek them not' (Je. 45:5) and that is a word we all have to take to heart. But the crucial point is the phrase 'for yourself'. At the same time we are told to be 'zealous for good deeds' (Tit. 2:14) a phrase which could be paraphrased 'be ambitious to do good'. It is easy to settle down and accept the mediocre, a way of life which is free from doing harm but which does not use our capacities for the glory of God or for the community. This Christian ambition may lead us to some decisions that surprise others. We may opt for teaching in a tough and unpopular area. We may not want the 'top' job. On the other hand it rightly leads some Christians to push to the top and to compete for posts which really develop their abilities in areas that the community or the profession badly needs. We are not meant always to be feverishly active, but we are told to 'be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, knowing that in the Lord your labour is not in vain.' (1 Cor. 15:58)

「你為自己圖謀大事麼？不要圖謀。」（耶45:5）這話我們都要謹記。要點就是「為自己」這片語。我們也要「熱心為善」（多2:14），這可解作「行善的抱負」。與世無爭和接受中庸之道是容易的，這生活方式免卻造成傷害的危險，卻沒有為着神的榮耀和為着社群用盡我們的才能。這基督徒的抱負也許領我們作使人驚奇的決定。我們也許選擇在艱苦和不受歡迎的地區教學，不想要那顯赫工作。另一方面，這正確地引領一些基督徒向高處推進，並爭取發揮在社區或專業範疇中十分需要的職位。這不是說總要狂熱地向前，而是「務要堅固，不可搖動，常常竭力，多作主工，因為知道你們的勞苦，在主裏面不是徒然的。」（林前15:58）

Guidance

Some Biblical Principles

引導

一些聖經的原則

Author: Oliver R. Barclay
作者：奧利華·R·百其利

Translator: Chow Woon Kuen
譯者：鄒煥權

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非拉鐵非書簡 (Books of Philadelphia) 08 《神的引導》

本書着重從研經來得神的引導。作者相信蒙引導的唯一安全方法就是嚴嚴守着聖經的原則。

《使徒行傳》和新約書信中，使徒常以所面對的處境作為尋常決定的引導。神引導走的沒有一條不是義路，就是這原因為甚麼我們常被忠告，我們若想蒙神引導的話，便要搜查和認識聖經了。

在人事物上有純潔和愛心取態的基督徒得見屬天的智慧。所應許我們的是，當我們謙卑來承認我們的無能，並用信來祈求時，我們必得賜能力來辨識甚麼是當作之事。這不會以一神奇的方式臨到，它也必不會叫我們脫離那小心計算下給我們的責任。所應許的是我們必能基督化地看問題。

我們是因着相信而不是感覺來得着喜樂和平安的。

聖靈的引導是藉着基於和忠於的聖經知識而來的智慧、判斷和勸告。